

The Authority is chaired by the Prime Minister and has as its members, the Chief Ministers of the States through which Ganga flows, viz., Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Jharkhand and West Bengal. The Union Ministers of Environment & Forests, Finance, Urban Development, Water Resources, Power, Science & Technology, Deputy Chairman, Planning Commission are also members of the Authority. 5 experts in the fields of environmental engineering, hydrology, river conservation and social mobilization will also be co-opted.

#### THE ROAD MAP

The Authority has both regulatory and developmental functions. The Authority will take measures for effective abatement of pollution and conservation of the river Ganga in keeping with sustainable development needs. These include:-

(b) maintenance of minimum ecological flows in the Ganga for ensuring water quality;

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(d) The Authority has the powers to issue directions under Section 5 of the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986 for performing its functions.

**This new initiative of the Government is expected to rejuvenate the collective efforts of the Centre and States for cleaning the river.**

